

Why does my heart beat?

Your heart beats to pump blood around your body through tubes called arteries and veins. Blood carries oxygen and nutrients (the goodness your body takes from your food) to give you energy.

Quick quiz

- ♥ What is your blood for?
- ♥ What is the name of your largest artery?
- ♥ What do white blood cells do?

Muscle power.....
Your heart is a powerful muscle that pumps blood without taking a rest. It beats around 100,000 times per day.

From the heart.....
Your arteries (shown in red) carry blood that contains oxygen from your heart to the cells around your body.

Return trip.....
When your body has used up all of the oxygen, your veins (shown in blue) carry your blood back to your heart to get more.

Going to your head

One-fifth of the blood in your body is pumped to your brain.

Largest artery

The aorta is the largest artery in your body. It is about as wide as your thumb.

